

Humana — Internal Pre-Meeting Prep

Account owner: Kyle Hix · **Prepared:** Oct 5, 2026 · **Fit score:** 77/100 (active prospect) · **Full brief:** next pages

Purpose of this meeting: agree on how we enter Humana, who we contact first, and what each of us owns. Medicare Annual Enrollment opens **Oct 15**, so the outreach window is now.

The account in 60 seconds

- **Scale:** 20,000+ member advocates handle up to **~80M member calls a year**. One of the largest inbound voice operations in U.S. healthcare.
- **Incumbent:** **Google Cloud** (Vertex AI / Gemini) powers *Agent Assist*, a copilot for human advocates, rolling out across member service centers through 2026. Humana claims \$100M+ in savings over a few years.
- **Gap:** No public evidence of AI that resolves calls on its own. Routine calls still reach a person. Reviews cite 30–45-minute holds.
- **Mandate:** On the Q2 call, the CEO said Humana wants to be "simpler, leaner and faster" and to lead with "automation and AI with best-performing vendors."
- **Timing:** Enrollment peak (Oct 15 – Dec 7) plus ~600K members getting plan-exit letters. A new CTO (Apr 2026) and CDO (Jul 2025) are both in their first year.

Decisions we need today

#	Decision	Options	Kyle's recommendation
1	Lead motion	(a) Direct: Voice Agent API for self-service, bake-off vs. Google speech · (b) Co-sell through their CCaaS partner	(a) now , switch to (b) if discovery shows Five9 / Amazon Connect / Twilio / Genesys
2	First door	CDO Damian Warren (digital and self-service) · CTO Bobby Mukundan (technical) · both	Both in parallel. Warren on the business case, Mukundan on the bake-off
3	Bake-off offer	Size, scope, and data handling	~500 real member calls; accuracy on member IDs, drug names, senior voices; latency; cost per hour; run in their VPC
4	Timing	Before Oct 15 vs. after the enrollment peak (Dec 7)	Before Oct 15 for the first touch, framed as "for your January / next enrollment period." Expect meetings to land in December or January
5	Exec involvement	Deepgram exec to CTO-level outreach?	Yes. Peer note to Mukundan (ex-CVS CIO, ex-JPMorgan CTO)

Who does what (assign owners)

Workstream	Owner	Due
Outreach to Damian Warren (CDO) + business-case email	Kyle Hix	Before Oct 15
Technical note + bake-off proposal for Bobby Mukundan (CTO)	Sales Engineer: _____	Before Oct 15
Ask Five9 / AWS / Twilio / Genesys partner teams whether Humana is their customer	Partner manager: _____	This week
Check our own CRM and console for existing humana.com sign-ups, usage, or past opportunities	_____	This week

Workstream	Owner	Due
Healthcare security pack (HIPAA BAA, VPC / on-prem, PHI handling) ready for procurement	_____	Before first meeting
Exec-to-exec note to CTO	Exec sponsor: _____	After partner check
Find the VP / Director of Member Services (contact center leader)	Kyle Hix / BDR: _____	This week

What we still don't know (and how we'll find out)

Unknown	Why it matters	How to find out
CCaaS / telephony platform	Decides direct vs. co-sell	Partner teams; job posts; ask in discovery
Speech engine under the IVR	Displacement target (Google? Nuance?)	Discovery Q4; SE network
BPO vendors for member calls	Savings case and timing of contract renewals	Discovery Q7; 10-K
Contact center leader's name	Champion with the most enrollment-season pain	Web search; LinkedIn via network
Any existing Deepgram footprint	Expansion vs. new logo	Internal CRM and console check

Risks to discuss

- **Google is entrenched.** It shipped a visible win and claims \$100M+ in savings, and may bundle Gemini virtual agents next. *Counter:* compete on measured accuracy, latency, and cost on their audio. Bring your own LLM, so they can keep Gemini as the brain.
- **Peak-season freeze.** Operations and IT may not take meetings from Oct 15 to Dec 7. *Counter:* aim the first touch at the 2027 roadmap and land meetings in December or January.
- **Vendor consolidation.** Humana is reducing vendors. *Counter:* position as replacing IVR speech and BPO spend, or deliver through a partner they already pay.
- **Compliance.** CMS marketing rules, HIPAA, and a senior population. *Counter:* VPC / on-prem deployment; start with low-risk informational intents.
- **Evidence quality.** Several facts in the brief come from search-result excerpts. Verify the linked sources before quoting them to Humana.

Proposed first customer meeting (30 min)

1. **Intros and purpose** (3 min)
2. **Their priorities:** 2027 self-service roadmap, enrollment-season results (7 min)
3. **Discovery:** top routine intents; speech engine under the IVR; authentication failure rate (10 min)
4. **Proof:** Five9 healthcare result (authentication rates doubled) plus a short live voice-agent demo (6 min)
5. **Next step:** agree on bake-off scope and a data-handling path (4 min)

Asks of the team

- Bring any Humana or health-plan relationships you have (former colleagues, partner contacts).
- SE: confirm we can run the bake-off in a Humana VPC and how long it takes to stand up.
- Marketing: do we have a payer / health-plan reference we can name?

Humana — Deepgram Account Brief

Generated 2026-10-05 · Depth: quick · Fit score: **77/100 (active prospect)** · Legend: [n] = sourced fact · **HYPOTHESIS** = hypothesis, verify · **Unknown** = not found

Facts come from web-search results, some from excerpts only. Open the source before quoting a number to Humana.

TL;DR

- **Who:** Major Medicare Advantage insurer. 20,000+ "member advocates" handle up to **~80M member calls a year** [1].
- **Why now:** Enrollment opens **Oct 15**. ~600K members just got plan-exit letters [3]. The CEO wants to lead with "automation and AI with best-performing vendors" [4].
- **Pain:** **HYPOTHESIS** Google-built Agent Assist helps advocates [2], but nothing resolves calls on its own. Members report 30–45 min holds [8].
- **Motion: Displacement + new use case.** Sell a voice self-service layer (Voice Agent API) and a bake-off vs. Google speech. Switch to **partner co-sell** if their CCaaS is Five9, Amazon Connect, Twilio, or Genesys.
- **Win: Bobby Mukundan** (CTO, Apr 2026) [5] and **Damian Warren** (CDO, Jul 2025) [6]. Both are in their first year, so their roadmaps are still open.
- **Ask:** "Agent Assist makes your 80M calls better. What's the plan for the calls that shouldn't need an advocate at all?"

1. Account Snapshot

Company	Health insurer (MA, Medicaid, Part D) + CenterWell care and pharmacy · Louisville, KY · NYSE: HUM
Scale	20,000+ advocates, ~80M calls/yr [1]. Added ~1M MA members in 2026 enrollment [9]
Strategy	CEO Jim Rehtin, Q2 2026: be "simpler, leaner and faster" and "lead on innovation by leveraging automation and AI with best-performing vendors" [4]
Financial signal	Operating cost ratio down 120 bps YoY through centralization and outsourcing [4]. Exiting weaker MA plans [3]
Relationship	No prior email contact with humana.com found in Gmail

2. Why Now

When	Trigger	So what for Deepgram
Oct 15 – Dec 7	Medicare Annual Enrollment	Biggest call spike of the year. Elastic capacity has a real deadline
Sept 2026	~600K members told their plan ends in 2027 [3]	Wave of repetitive "what happens to my plan?" calls, ideal for automation
Aug 2026	Q2 call: AI "with best-performing vendors" [4]	Executive mandate to buy, not build
Apr 2026	Bobby Mukundan named SVP & CTO [5]	New technical decision-maker
Oct 2025 → 2026	Agent Assist (Google Cloud) rolling out [2]	Contact center is modernizing now. Self-service is the next step

3. Contact Center & Stack

Layer	Vendor (evidence)	Class → implication
CCaaS / telephony	Unknown	Decides direct sale vs. partner co-sell. Discovery Q2

Layer	Vendor (evidence)	Class → implication
Speech engine / IVR	Unknown. <i>HYPOTHESIS</i> likely Google under Agent Assist	Competitor → bake-off on their audio
Agent assist	Google Cloud, Vertex AI / Gemini [2]	Competitor (assist only, no containment)
CRM	Salesforce Health Cloud, 2020 deal STALE [7]	Integration path via function calling
Agent guidance	Balto (vendor's own claim) [10]	Either → find Balto's speech engine

Ops & hiring: "Outsourcing" is a cost lever [4], but the BPO vendors are **Unknown**. Reviews cite long holds and repeat calls [8]. Hiring data is **Unknown** (job boards blocked this run).

4. Buying Committee

Person	Background	Likely role
Damian Warren , SVP & Chief Digital Officer (Jul 2025) [6]	Ex-U.S. Bank head of consumer digital channels	Champion for self-service
Bobby Mukundan , SVP & CTO (Apr 2026) [5]	Ex-CVS Health CIO, ex-JPMorgan global CTO, ex-Accenture	Technical approver; bake-off owner
Japan Mehta , CIO (Feb 2025) [11]	Owens IT, digital & AI, transformation	Approver; AI vendor strategy
David Dintenfass , President, Enterprise Growth [11]	Ex-Fidelity CMO and head of CX design	Exec sponsor for member experience
Contact center leader	Unknown (VP Member Services / Consumer Ops)	Champion with the most enrollment-season pain

5. Pain → Deepgram Fit

Signal	<i>HYPOTHESIS</i> Pain	Deepgram answer + proof
80M calls, AI only assists [1] [2]	Routine calls (ID cards, claims, Rx, provider lookup) burn advocate minutes	Voice Agent API resolves top intents end to end
Seniors speaking member IDs, drug names	Recognition errors push callers to agents	Alphanumeric accuracy. Five9 healthcare client doubled authentication rates [12]
30–45 min holds [8]; enrollment surge [3]	Abandonment, repeat calls, Star-rating risk	Instant answer, 24/7, elastic peak capacity
HIPAA / CMS rules	Compliance stalls AI pilots	VPC / on-prem deployment. Elerian AI (banking, on-prem) [13]

ROI sketch: 80M calls [1] × 30–40% automatable × 50–60% contained × \$3–\$5 saved per call (assumed) ≈ **\$36M–\$96M/yr**. Even the low case, over three years, matches Humana's own \$100M+ Agent Assist target [2].

6. Talk Track & Objections

- **Opener:** "You've shown with Agent Assist that AI pays off across 80 million calls. Deepgram helps health plans take the next step: voice agents that resolve routine calls before they reach an advocate."
- **Angles:** *CTO/CIO:* a bake-off on Humana's own audio vs. Google, run in their VPC. *CDO:* voice becomes a digital channel with the same intents as the app. *Contact center:* coverage for enrollment and January peaks.
- **Proof:** Five9 healthcare client doubled authentication rates [12]. Abby Connect runs an AI receptionist handling 100K+ calls/month [14].

Objection	Response
"We have AI: Agent Assist with Google."	That improves human calls. We remove the calls that don't need a human. The two work together.
"We're standardized on Google."	Keep Gemini as the LLM (bring your own LLM). Compete on accuracy, latency, and cost, measured on their calls.
"Seniors won't talk to a bot."	Natural speech beats press-1 menus. Offer an instant zero-out to an advocate and measure CSAT.
"We're consolidating vendors."	Replace IVR speech and BPO spend, or deliver through the CCaaS partner they already pay.

7. Discovery Questions

1. What share of the ~80M calls are routine intents, and how are they handled today?
2. Which IVR / CCaaS platform sits in front of the advocates, and when is the contract up?
3. Who owns voice self-service for 2027: Digital, IT, or Operations?
4. Which speech engine runs under the IVR and Agent Assist? Is Google pitching virtual agents?
5. Would you run a bake-off on a sample of real member calls?

8. Next Best Actions

1. **Before Oct 15:** Email Damian Warren with the enrollment / plan-exit surge angle. Ask for 20 minutes with his self-service lead.
2. Send Bobby Mukundan a technical note offering a **500-call bake-off** in their VPC, citing the Five9 authentication result.
3. Ask Deepgram partner teams (Five9, AWS, Twilio, Genesys) whether Humana is a customer. That reveals the CCaaS platform and any co-sell path.
4. Identify the VP of Member Services. Rerun **--deep** before the first meeting.

Fit score: Volume 30/30 · Pain 22/25 · Timing 18/20 · Stack 10/15 · Access 2/10 · Competitor adj -5 = **77/100**

Sources

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